St. Michael and All Angels Church
(Listed Grade II*)
Mickleham, Surrey



A Guide to the oldest part of St. Michael's Churchyard

Compiled by Carole Brough Fuller

£2.50

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There was a church on this site over a thousand years ago, probably as far back as the year 950 in the time of King Edward. At this time Mickleham was part of the estates of the Bishop of Baieux. The original church was a small Saxon one consisting of just a nave and chancel and parts of this are incorporated in the present structure. St. Michael's was mentioned in the Doomsday Book that at the time of the general survey (1081-1086) 'there was a church and two acres of meadow at Mickleham'.

From the Middle Ages onward, the Christian grave represented a sleeping place from which death would be overcome at the time of resurrection and until the nineteenth century, most people were buried in the few acres around a church. Traditionally, the spot in the churchyard safest from ghouls, vampires and evil spirits was the ground next to the east wall of the church, nearest the altar. For added protection nobles and wealthy Commoners were buried beneath the church floor. Paupers' graves, however, were repeatedly reused or overburied. Hence, the ground level rose and boundary walls became necessary to support the soil to prevent collapse. Previously, churchyards had not been enclosed at all. Today the churchyard offers a place for peace and quiet contemplation, giving solace to the bereaved and others who may visit.

Although the Register of Burials for St. Michael's begins in 1549, the earliest memorials date from the 1700's and after 300 years of weathering, many sadly are now illegible. However, they still stand as a reminder of those who played their part in village life in years gone by.

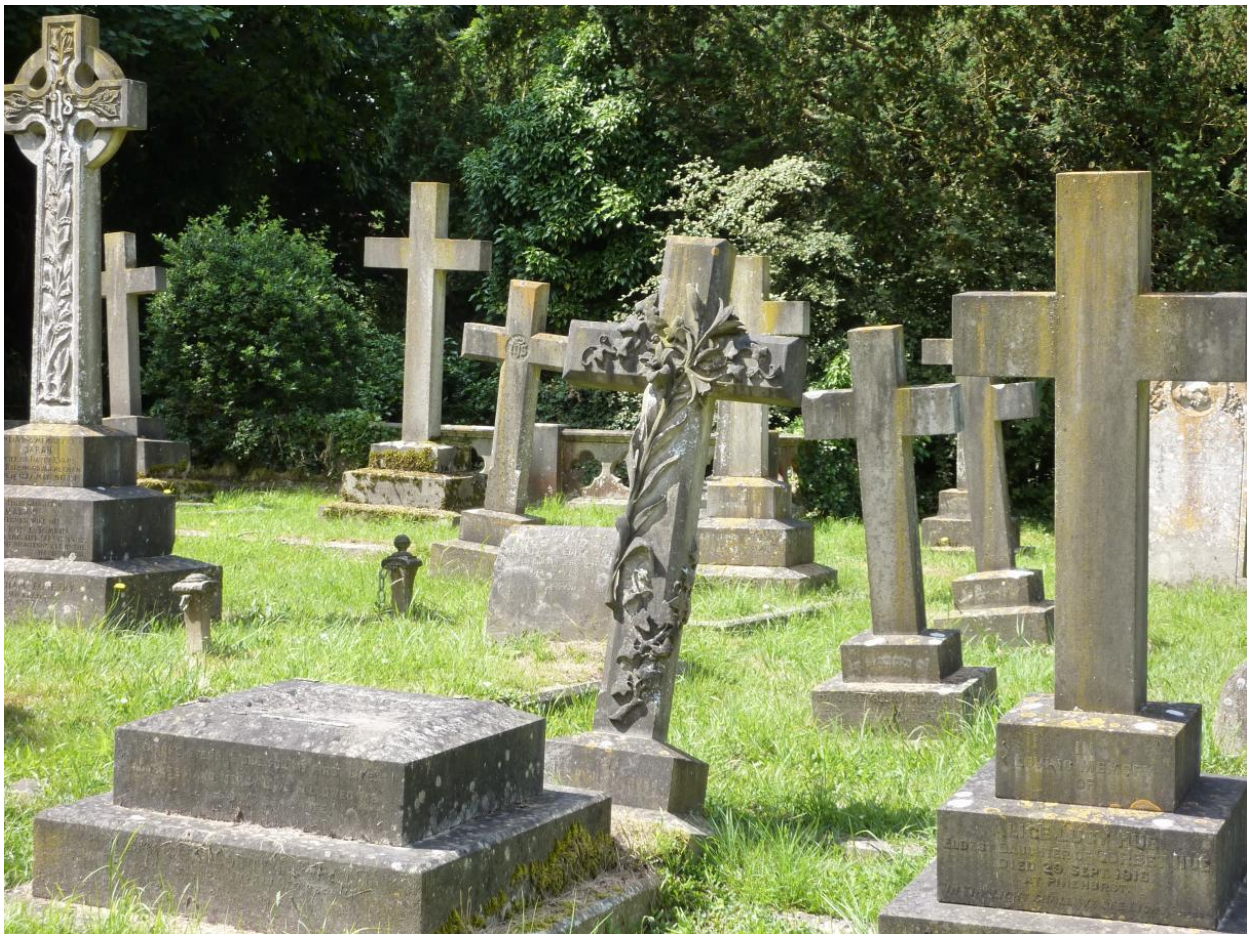
In 1837 civil registration was introduced in addition to parish records and we now have a more accurate record of the past.

The majority of St Michael's old registers and records can be viewed at the Surrey History Centre in Woking where they are kept for posterity.

The word ‘graveyard’ for many can conjure up the image of a haven for spirits, rather than a peaceful and worthy social history of past times. However, on closer inspection, people often find a churchyard to be an interesting record of who’s who, as well as a place for peaceful contemplation and solace.

St. Michael’s is indeed such a place. It is hoped that this short guide with its information and photographs, will help you to explore the peace and tranquillity of the earliest part of the churchyard.

Of course the weathered stones and their epitaphs speak with far greater detail and more eloquence than is possible in this guide.



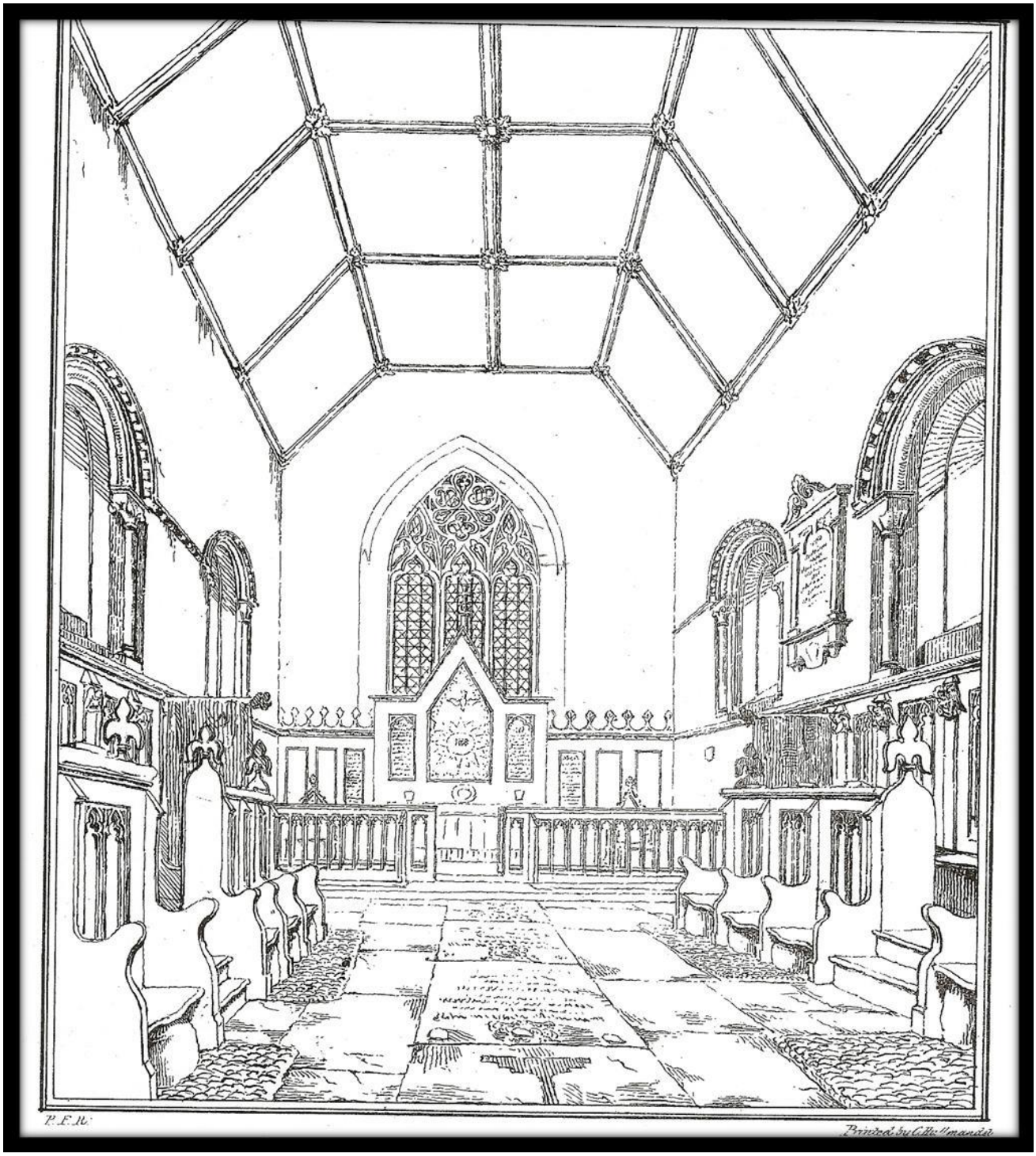
Then and Now



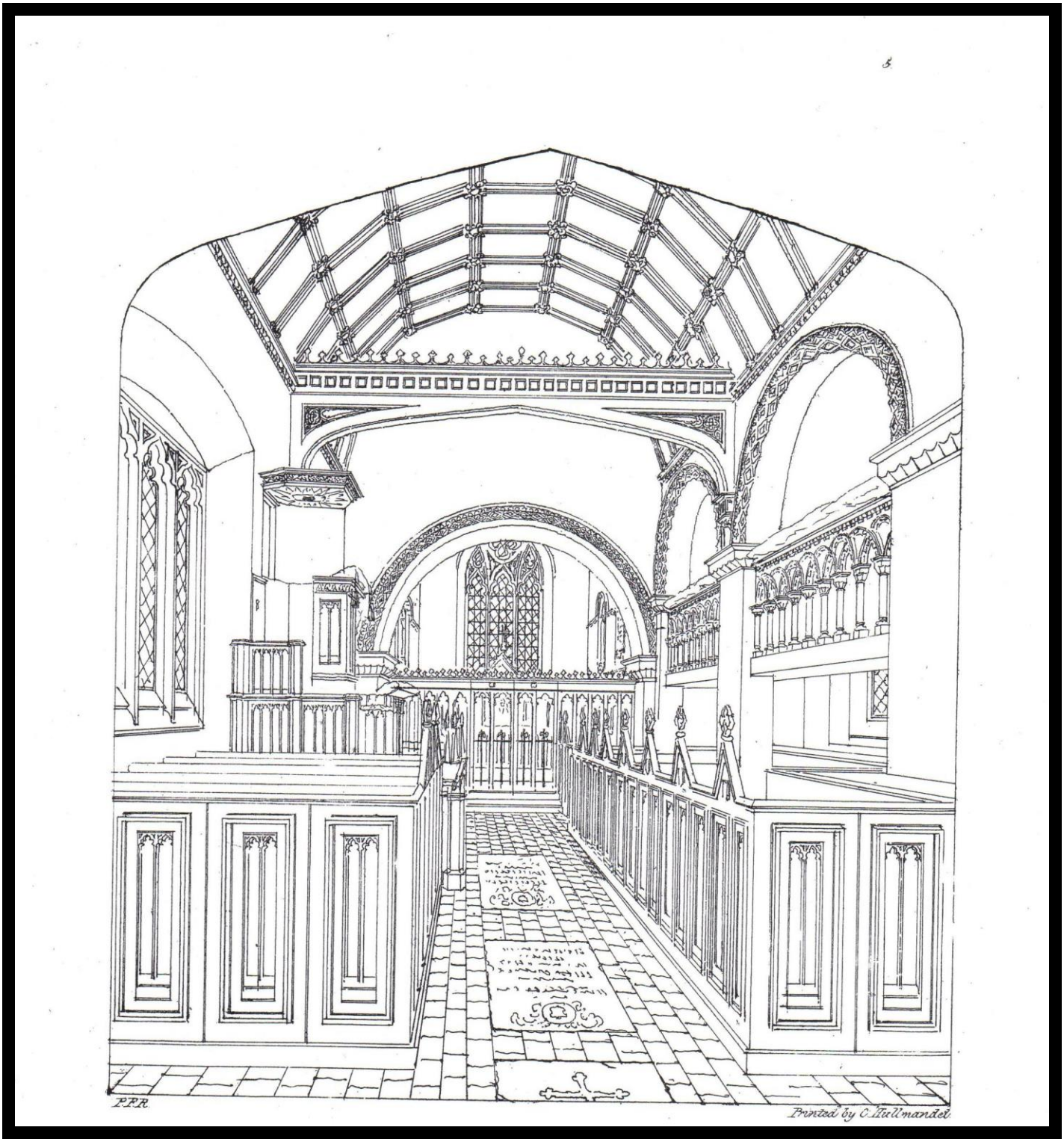
1820’s by C.T. Cracklow



2009 photo by John Wettern



View of chancel with tombstones **Circa early 1800's**

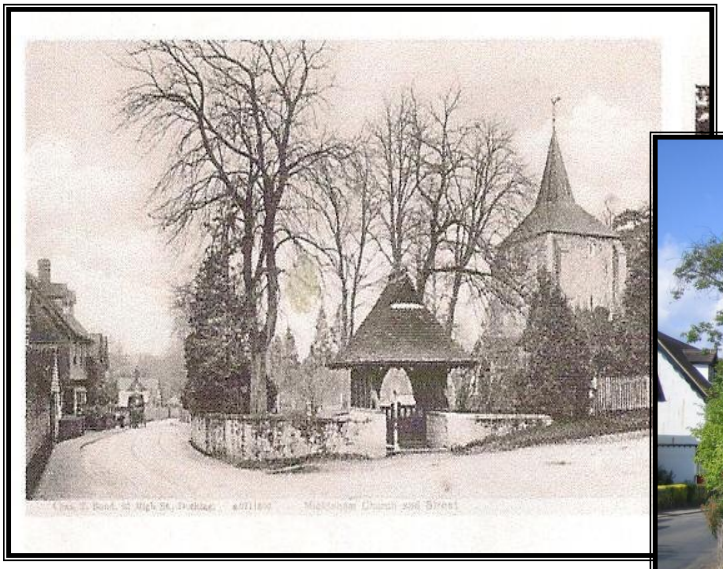


View looking East **Circa early 1800's**

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(1) Lych Gate (Listed Grade II)

Mr T. Bryant of *Bryant and May*, manufacturer of matches, who lived at Juniper Hill, erected the Lych Gate in 1898. It is listed by English Heritage as Grade II and the listing reads as follows:

Lych Gate:

Probably late nineteenth century rubblestone with ashlar quoins and coping; wooden superstructure and gate; hipped plain tile roof with gablets and later decorative ridge tiles and finial. Well carved woodwork including cusped tracery in Perpendicular style; moulded arch braces and head bosses supporting inscribed tie beams; central braced king-post truss. Inside, gables are plastered with cherubs in relief. A good quality lych gate which has strong group value with the Church.

Theodore Henry Bryant was a partner in the family firm of patent safety match manufacturers *Bryant and May*. He bought Juniper Hill in 1884, and lived there with his wife and six children until 1899. As well as erecting the Lych Gate, in 1887 he also erected a marble tablet in the church to commemorate Queen Victoria's Jubilee. The tablet is a medallion portrait by Mr. F. J. Williamson of Esher and was modelled from sittings given at Windsor Castle in December 1886.

Lych Gates were erected for the benefit of coffin bearers so that they could rest and if necessary shelter from the elements. It is considered bad luck for a bride to come into church through the Lych gate but it is quite acceptable to leave by it!

Look up and you will see the following inscriptions carved in the roof:

I know That My Redeemer Liveth

So Teach Us To Number Our Days

That We Can Apply Our Hearts

Because I Live Ye Shall Live Also



Also note that of the four carved heads, two are male and two female. I wonder who they were modelled on?



By Lych Gate

(2) Scrolls

Interestingly, these are not headstones at all but ‘No Ball Games’ signs crafted in stone to fit in with the surrounding area of the churchyard and erected at a later date to most of the tombstones here.



By Old London Road entry into churchyard



(3) Graveboards

Wooden memorials were common during the seventeenth century in Surrey and the Weald and in other parts of south-east England where there was little local stone. These graveboards consisted of a wooden rail fixed between two uprights or supported on two crucks. They were usually inscribed on both sides. Unfortunately, they do not weather very well.

The first photograph of our graveboard at St. Michael's appears in a book titled 'Discovering Epitaphs' by Geoffrey N.Wright written in 1972 and reprinted in 2004. Note the spelling of the inscription:

** Farwell all my friends so kind*
I Hope in Heaven my soul you'll find

The second photograph is a recent one and shows the graveboard after its restoration of ten years ago.

The inscription on the other side reads:

In memory of John Walker who died
January 23rd 1813 Age 83 years



* Farwell is an abbreviation of "Fare thee well".

(4) During the 2009 vestry extension ....

The (not-unexpected) discovery of burials brought the building work to a rapid halt.







The resultant Archaeological Assessment had the following significant findings:

- A total of 17 inhumations were identified, two of which constituted a double burial (adult/juvenile). Seven were present as one complex group.
- All of the burials were oriented east/west.
- Most had been damaged by more recent intrusions.
- The depth of burials was shallow (0.4m - 0.8m) reflecting previous levelling for the former Victorian vestry footprint.
- Some of the burials had associated iron coffin grips/nails, and iron and copper shroud /upholstery pins.
- The burials must predate the construction of the previous vestry in 1823.
- The ironwork is consistent with the late 18th/early 19th century.
- There was evidence of Roman pottery and ceramics, all of similar date.

- The pottery was Alice Holt/Farnham ware (AD 250-400) with tiles similar to finds in Ewell for which there was a production area on Ashtead Common (AD 140-250). There were also box flue tile remains. The report states: the presence of box flue tiles suggests a heated building, raising the possibility of a villa or bath-house at or close to the site.
- Given the early (Saxon) origins of the church, it is possible that it was built on a previous high-status Roman site.

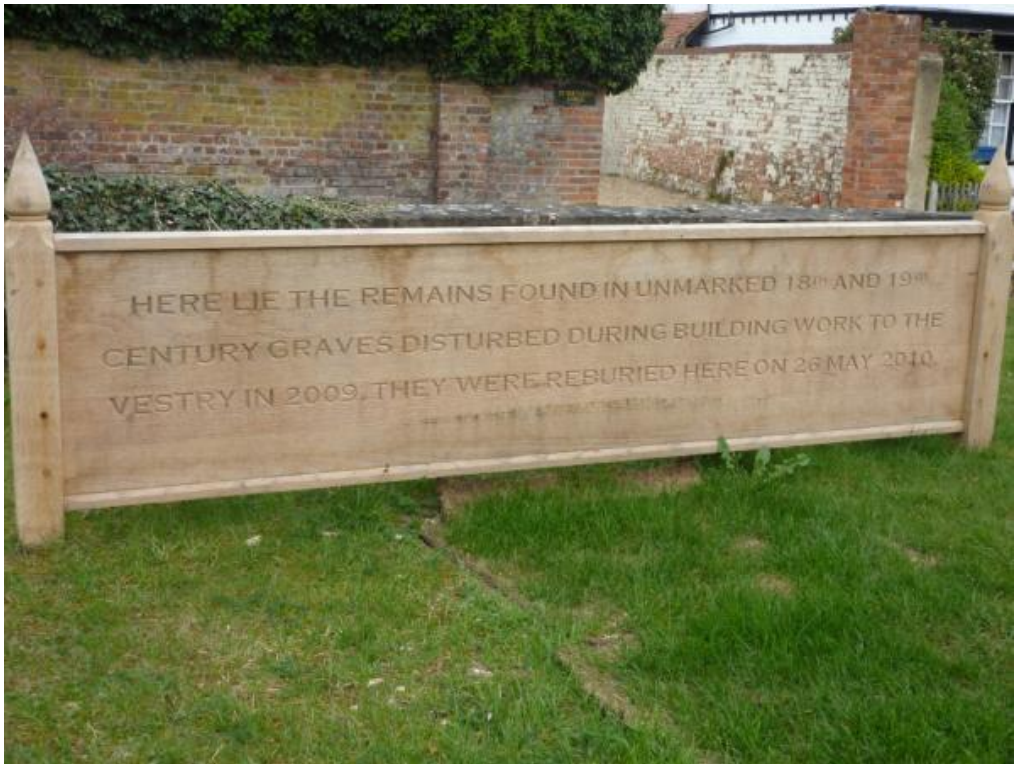
Now fully recorded, the bones were re-interred at a simple ceremony just inside the lych gate during 2010. The plaque on the coffin reads:-

May the souls of the faithful departed, through the mercy of God, Rest in Peace.





A wooden graveboard now marks the place with the original burial date, and explanatory text.



Here lie the remains found in unmarked 18th and 19th Century graves disturbed during building work to the vestry in 2009. They were reburied here on 26th May 2010.





(5) The Right Honourable Richard Bedford Bennett (1870 – 1947)

R. B. Bennett was born on 3rd July 1870 at Hopewell Hill, New Brunswick, and went on to become prime minister of Canada in 1930.

A bachelor lawyer who had prospered in Alberta, Bennett was elected to the House of Commons in 1911 and became Conservative leader in 1927. After winning the federal election of 1930, he tried to fight the depression by expanding trade within the British Empire. He established a number of fundamental Canadian institutions including a central bank and a national broadcasting system. A strong supporter of the British Commonwealth, he saw the British Parliament recognise Canada as a sovereign nation in 1931.



In 1935, Bennett changed tactics introducing his 'New Deal' of public spending and federal intervention in the economy. Nevertheless, his Conservative Party was swept away in that year's election. He then retired to England in 1938 and later sat in the House of Lords as Viscount Bennett.

He lived at Juniper Hill in Mickleham where he installed a cinema in the basement and often invited his local friends to Sunday evening film shows. His greatest friend being Max, Baron Beaverbrook who lived not far away at Cherkley Court in Leatherhead.

Bennett died at Mickleham on 26th June 1947 just days before his 77th birthday. He is the only Canadian prime minister buried outside Canada.

Inside the church in the Norbury Chapel which dates from about 1300, there are windows commemorating Richard Bennett and his two nephews who died in Normandy in 1944.

The first, larger window, is in the east wall of the chapel and shows on the left side, in the upper part, the Arms of Viscount Bennett and the lower part contains the following inscription:

In memory of Richard Bedford, Viscount Bennett of Juniper Hill, Mickleham, a benefactor of this church, sometime Prime Minister of Canada, who died on the 26th day of June 1947, aged 76 years.

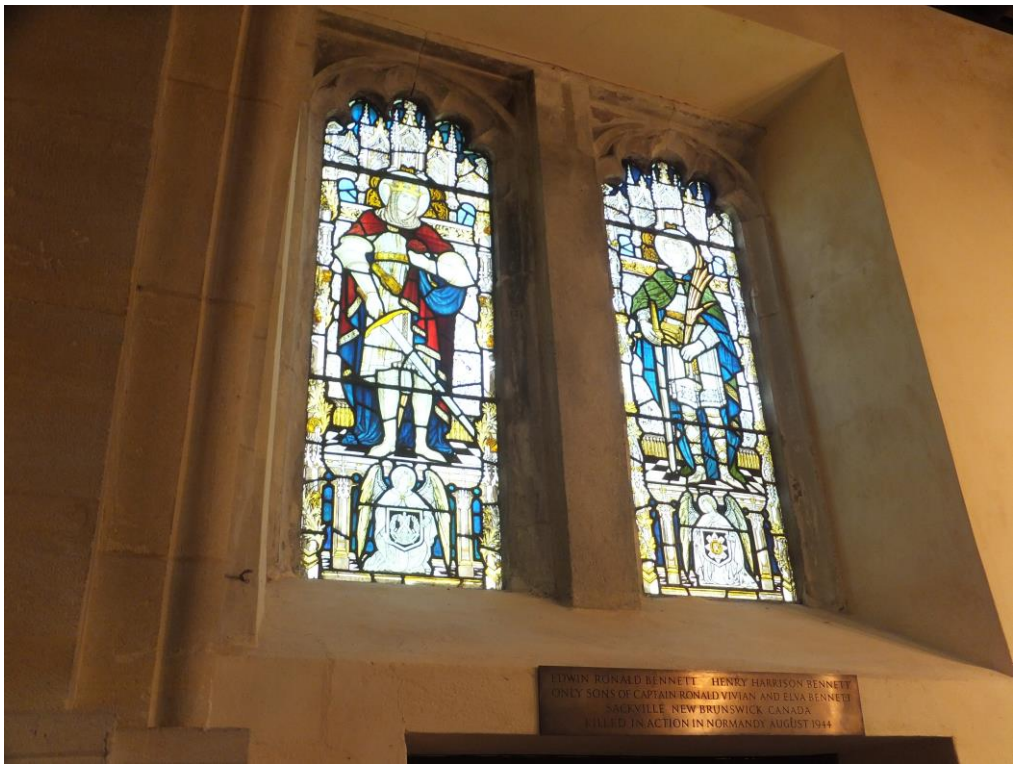


The second, smaller window, is above the door in the north wall of the chapel. It shows on the left a standing medieval soldier with a halo holding a sword and wearing an ancient crown over a chainmail head covering. In the lower part, a kneeling angel is holding a shield with a representation of the cap badge of The Cameron Highlanders of Ottawa.

On the right there is again a standing medieval soldier with a halo holding a sword in the right hand and a palm branch of martyrdom in the left hand. In the lower part, a kneeling angel is holding a shield with the representation of the cap badge of The Black Watch, Royal Highland Regiment of Canada.

The dedication on the brass plaque below the window is to the memory of:

Edwin Ronald Bennett and Henry Harrison Bennett
only sons of Captain Ronald Vivian and Elva Bennett,
Sackville, New Brunswick, Canada,
killed in action in Normandy, August 1944.



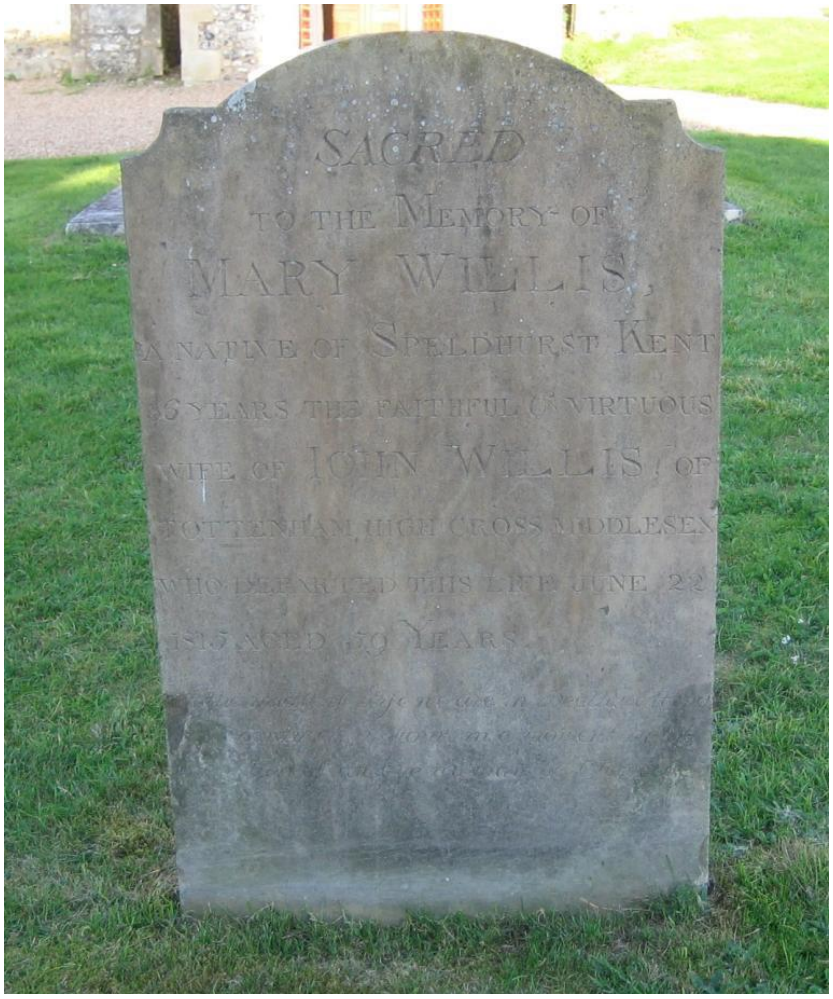
On Monday 5th August 2002 members of the Canadian Government, relatives of Richard Bennett, the Bishop of Guildford, the Dean and Archdeacon of Dorking attended a service at St. Michael's to install a new plaque at his grave site.



The service was conducted in both English and French and afterwards refreshments were served at Juniper Hill. The Canadian Government invited the parish to join them in this ceremony.

At the same time as installing the new plaque, the High Commissioner of Canada planted a Maple Tree to the right of the church alongside the Southern boundary wall.





(6) Mary Willis (1756 – 1815)

An interesting inscription:

SACRED

TO THE MEMORY OF

MARY WILLIS

A NATIVE OF SPELDHURST KENT

66 YEARS THE FAITHFUL & VIRTUOUS

WIFE OF JOHN WILLIS OF

TOTTENHAM HIGH CROSS MIDDLESEX

WHO DEPARTED THIS LIFE JUNE 22

1815 AGED 59 YEARS



(7) William Skeet (1777 – 1827)

Another interesting inscription:

Sacred

To

The Memory of

WILLIAM SKEET

Who departed this life

February 26 1827

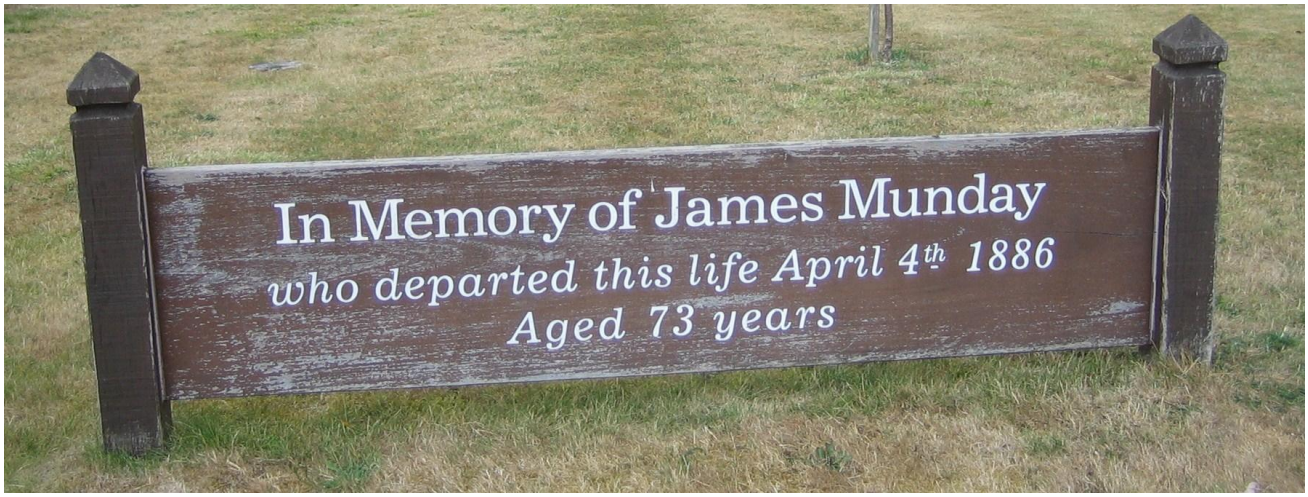
Aged 50 Years

Take notice all you that do pass by

As you are now so once was I

As I am now so must you be

Prepare yourselves to follow me



(8) Graveboard

This is another restored graveboard with the following inscription:

In Memory of James Munday
who departed this life April 4th 1886

Aged 73 Years

On the other side:

In Memory of Mary Munday
who departed this life March 31st 1886

Aged 86 Years

Both husband and wife died within four days of each other.



(9) Wall

This part of the boundary wall, between the churchyard and the new rectory, is rather unusual in that it contains two carved stone heads and a dedication tablet as follows:

THIS WALL WAS ERECTED
IN MEMORY OF

HAZELL WILLIAM LLOYD

OF THE DIGNARIES WESTHUMBLE

1881 – 1951

AND

ELEANOR MURIEL FAUX LLOYD
1887 – 1967

LAUS DEO

Perhaps there is a story behind these carvings?



(10) Dame Philippa Browne (1624 – 1701)

A very old full-length flat tombstone near the steeple with the following inscription:

Here lyeth the body of Dame Philippa Browne, widow & relict of Sir Adam Browne late of Betchworth Castle, Bart who died on the 20th day of May anno. dom. 1701, aged 77.

Here also lies the body of Margaret Cooper beloved niece of the said Dame Philippa, who dyed the 31st of March 1704.

This grave could not be any closer to the church without being inside, where the gentry of the parish aspired to be.



(11) Mary Flatt (1804 – 1886)

An upright headstone in memory of a faithful servant of the church as reflected in the inscription:

This stone is erected

In Memory of

Mary Flatt

Who for upwards of 40 Years

Faithfully fulfilled her duty

As pew opener and caretaker

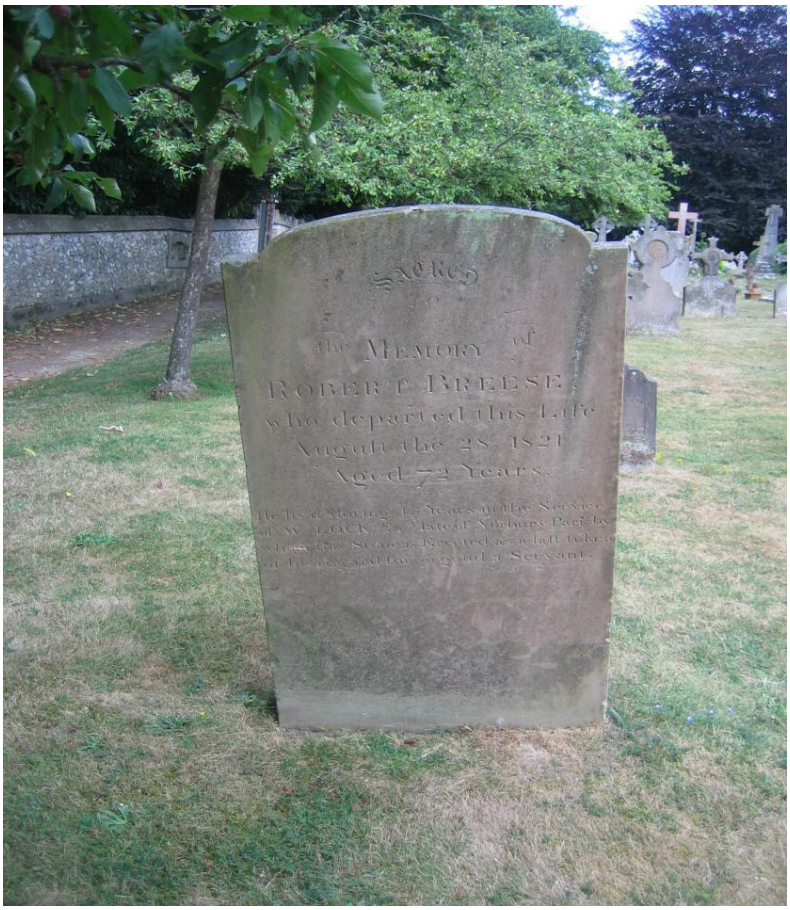
of this church

She died 26th January 1886

Aged 82 Years

The Blood of Jesus Christ his son

Cleanseth us from all sin



(12) Robert Breese (1749 – 1821)

Robert was the Head Gardener at Norbury Park for fifteen years. See inscription:

SACRED

To

The memory of

ROBERT BREESE

Who departed this life

August the 28th 1821

He lived during 15 Years in the service

Of Wm LOCK Esq late of Norbury Park

By whom this stone was Erected as a last token

Of his regard for so good a servant

Robert Breese married his first wife Jemima Benge at St. Olave's church in Southwark on 27th June 1779. She died and was buried on 14th September 1800. He married secondly, at the age of 53, Susannah Gertrude Arnold at St. Marylebone Church in London on 11th September 1802. Her father was steward to Robert's employer William Lock junior. Robert had worked for William Lock senior who left him £65 in his will of 1810. Susannah's father was left £125 in the same will. For a gentleman such as William Lock senior who bought the neglected Norbury Park in 1774, a talented gardener was one of his most important employees. Much of the parkland he created is now owned by Surrey County Council and open to the public.

Robert died at the age of 72 in 1821 and Susannah in 1846 aged 77.

(There is a funeral hatchment for William Lock junior in the nave of the church near the Norman font, high up on the wall above a walk in cupboard).





(13) Elisabeth Vulliamy (1800 - 1863)
Justin Theodore Vulliamy (1787 - 1870)

These two headstones, side by side, commemorate husband and wife Elisabeth and Justin Vulliamy.

Justin Theodore Vulliamy served in the peninsular war with the Duke of Wellington and was awarded the peninsular medal. On leaving the army he joined his elder brother, Benjamin Lewis Vulliamy, as a partner in the famous family clock-making firm and in 1822 was made Senior Warden of the Clockmakers Company. The firm held the Royal Warrant and compiled a catalogue of 193 clocks in the Crown's possession for George IV, soon after his succession in 1820.

Around about 1824, Justin left the family firm and moved to France with his new wife Elisabeth and started a woollen manufacturing business. Although this prospered he decided on retirement in 1857 to return to England and settle in Mickleham. It was here that his youngest child Marie, born in France in 1840, met George Meredith, Queen Victoria's favourite poet, and became his second wife. They were married in St. Michael's church on 20th September 1864, and lie together in Dorking Cemetery close to the Anglican Chapel.

Elizabeth Vulliamy was also born in France in 1833, one of the seven children of Justin and Elisabeth. The family, who were of Swiss origin, lived at 'The Old House', Mickleham Vale, which they leased from William Rogers, Rector of St. Botolphs, Bishopsgate and chaplain-in-ordinary to Queen Victoria. It was Miss Vulliamy who arranged with Thomas Grissell of Norbury Park for the barn at the foot of Crabtree Lane to be converted to a chapel for the welfare of the navvies working on the building of the railway tunnel at Westhumble. She organised mission services on Sunday, complete with hymns on the harmonium and reputedly helped the navvies to compose letters home, many of them having left their families in Ireland. There was also a bible class in the afternoon.

Once the railway was built the navvies moved on, but the barn never reverted to its original use. In 1904 it was decided to upgrade the building as a Chapel of Ease to St. Michael's in Mickleham. The first service took place on April 18th 1904 and was performed by the Bishop of Winchester. Services are still conducted here today.



The Chapel of Ease 1904



Photograph of Elizabeth Vulliamy (left) and Marie Meredith, nee Vulliamy, taken at Juniper Hill on a tennis afternoon. It comes from the photograph album 1885-1888 of Theodore Henry Bryant of Juniper Hill and of *Bryant and May* safety match manufacturers.
See (1) Lych Gate on page 7.



(14) Maria Drummond (1816 - 1891)

MARIA DRUMMOND BORN 21st MAY 1816 DIED AT FREDLEY 15 JANUARY 1891
WE PRAISE THEE O GOD: WE ACKNOWLEDGE THEE TO BE THE LORD

EMILY DRUMMOND OF FREDLEY BORN DUBLIN 18 DECEMBER 1837 DIED IN LONDON 25 MAY 1930. REST IN PEACE

Edith Bill Drummond (aged 46 years) of 4 Dorset Square, London was also interred in this grave on 31st October 1917.

This is a grand, full length, raised, red granite tomb to Maria Drummond of Fredley who died on 15 January 1891 often described as an accomplished, attractive and intelligent woman. As Maria Kinnaird, orphaned by a volcanic eruption on the West Indian Island of St Vincent, she was adopted by the unmarried politician Richard Sharp F.R.S. who was known as 'Conversation Sharp' because of his remarkable powers of entertaining friends with his lively and intelligent conversation. He attracted a wide circle of intellectuals to Fredley Cottage in Mickleham, including the poet William Wordsworth. On his death he left the Fredley Estate to Maria in his will.

Maria married Thomas Drummond the Under Secretary of State for Ireland and in 1860 built a new larger manor house named Fredley House on the estate on top of a knoll which had a very fine view of Norbury Park, Box Hill and Denbies. Mr Drummond will always be remembered for his famous words 'property has its duties, as well as its rights.' He is the one Englishman (save Nelson) to whom a statue has been erected by the Irish people in Dublin. On her husband's

death Maria continued to live at Fredley with her youngest daughter Emily.

On the death of Emily, at the age of 92, on 25th May 1930, Surrey County Council bought the estate as the Highways Committee had plans to build a by-pass to cope with the ever increasing traffic through Mickleham, what we now know as the A24 dual-carriageway. Fredley House became St. Faith's Home for children for over fifty years, before reverting back to a private dwelling as it still is to this day.

There is a light fitting in Maria's memory in the gallery of the church. It has a dedication around it in red and gold lettering as follows:

IN MEMORIUM MARIA DRUMMOND FROM M.E.K. AND E.D. OF FREDLEY 1892



(15) Joseph Kay M.A., Q.C. (1821 – 1878)

Joseph Kay, Queen's Council died at Fredley on 9th October 1878. He was the husband of Mary Drummond the second daughter of Maria Drummond who is buried close by with her other two daughters.

He was born at Ordsal Cottage, Salford in 1821 and was educated at Trinity College, Cambridge. He graduated with honours and was called to the Bar in 1848 and went on the Northern Circuit. He was made a Q.C. on 23rd June 1869 and was then elected a Bencher of the Inner Temple in May 1870. Joseph Kay was judge of the Salford Court of Record and was also Solicitor-General for the County Palatine of Durham. He unsuccessfully contested Salford for the Liberals in 1874 and again in 1877. He was also the author of "Education in England and Europe, 1850", "Poor Children in English and German Towns" and other writings.

His memorial is a Celtic cross on a plinth as follows:



BLESSED ARE
THE PURE IN HEART
FOR THEY
SHALL SEE GOD

JOSEPH KAY
M•A Q•C
BORN AT SALFORD•1821
DIED AT FREDLEY•1878
•AGED 57•

MARY•ELIZABETH
WIDOW OF JOSEPH•KAY
BORN IN IRELAND•1836
DIED AT FREDLEY•1924



(16) Burmester Gate
(Listed Grade II)

(Restored in 2010 by the owners of The Old Rectory).

The gate which leads from the churchyard to the old rectory is known as the Burmester Gate and is listed Grade II by English Heritage.

The listing dated 28/11/1951 reads:

Burmester Gate:

Gateway and gates in form of folly. Circa 1870. Wooden, including poles and wattles, with cast iron ornamentation and studs and tiled roof. Front to churchyard has round-headed arch and double pilasters filled-in with wattles with a tiled gable above, also decorated with pieces of wattles. Rear has arch and two square pilasters of horizontal wattles and poles. Attached wooden gates, each having six open panels with iron studs, decorative dog grates and trefoil-shaped finials. This was on the path between the Old Rectory and St. Michael's Church and is a garden folly as well as a gateway.

Reverend Alfred Burmester, after whom the gate was named, held the living at St. Michael's for 54 years. In 1840 he gave some Flemish panels and carved figures to the church for the decoration of the pulpit. These can still be seen today and are said to date from the sixteenth century. He also arranged for some additional carving to be added by sculptors that he sent to Belgium to be trained.

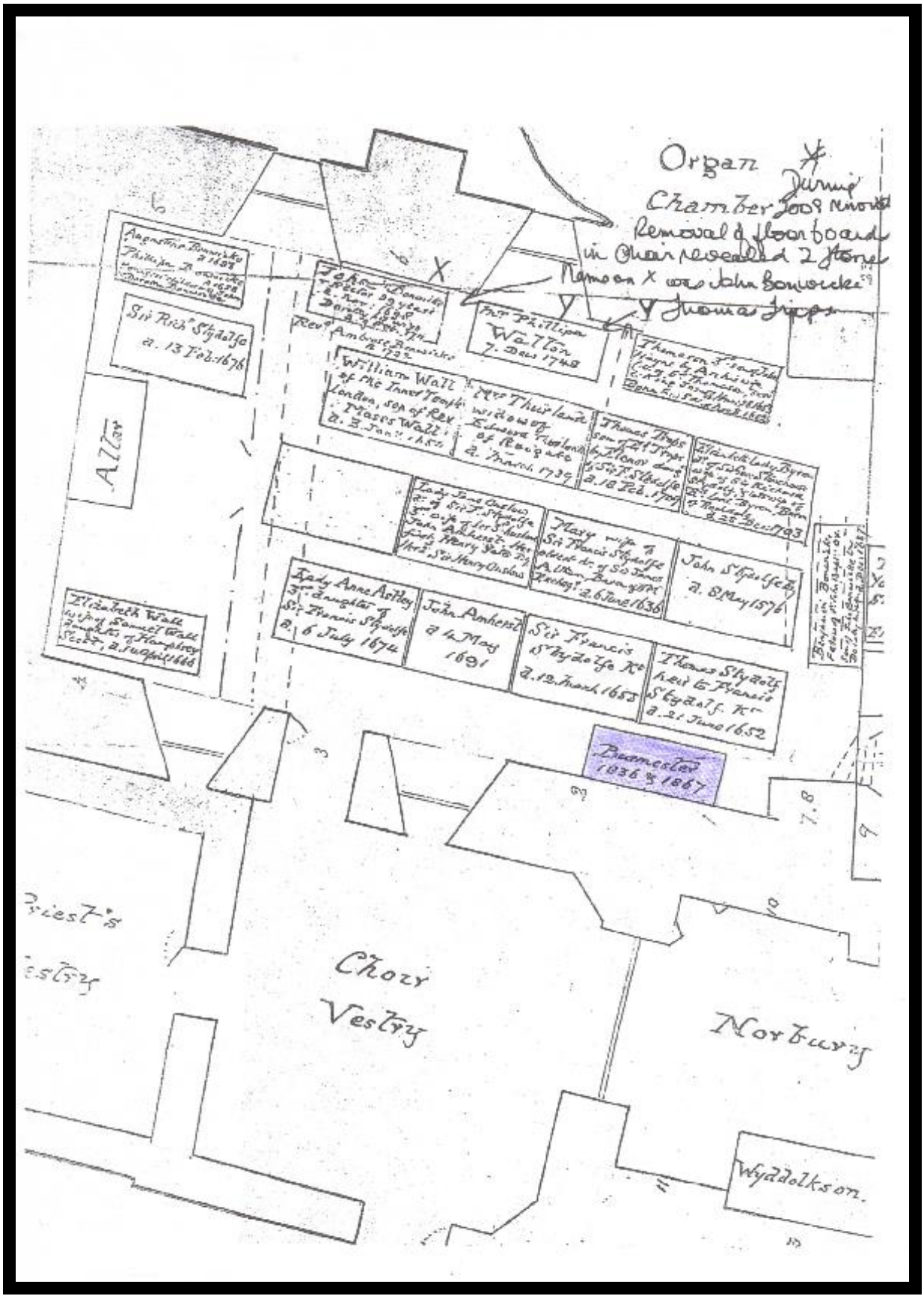
He served the parish faithfully until his death on 26th August 1867 aged 80 years and is buried in the chancel (see purple shading on diagram overleaf), close to a white marble wall tablet erected to his memory. Five years later in 1872 his daughter, Mrs Early Cook, commissioned the small stained glass windows in the chancel also in his memory.

His memorial tablet reads:

Sacred to the memory of
The Revd Alfred Burmester, M.A.
Of Trinity College, Cambridge,
Who departed this life on the 26th day of August 1867
In the 81st year of his age.
He was for upwards of 54 years rector of this parish
During which period this church was enlarged and greatly improved
The schools and almshouses erected
And several other parochial charities established.

Reverend Burmester was described by G.L. Rose, who kept Roses Stores in the latter part of the nineteenth century, as a man of fine physique and a great walker. He was often accompanied on his rambles by Mr Howard the schoolmaster. He also loved to eat oysters which were delivered by the fishmonger to the Rectory gate. Apparently a man of iron nerve and rather vain, he often posed at night in front of the vestry mirror in his surplice and then prowled around the church, sometimes surprising the organist at a late organ practise.

As well as a Minister, he was a Magistrate and sat on the local Bench where his parishioners sometimes appeared before him. He was also very fond of his food and was known as a "three bottle man". It would appear that he was a little prejudiced and when Miss Vulliamy began the services to Navvies at the Barn in Westhumble, now the Chapel of Ease, he suggested "she had better stay at home and mend her stockings".



Floor plan of the Chancel **Late 1800's**

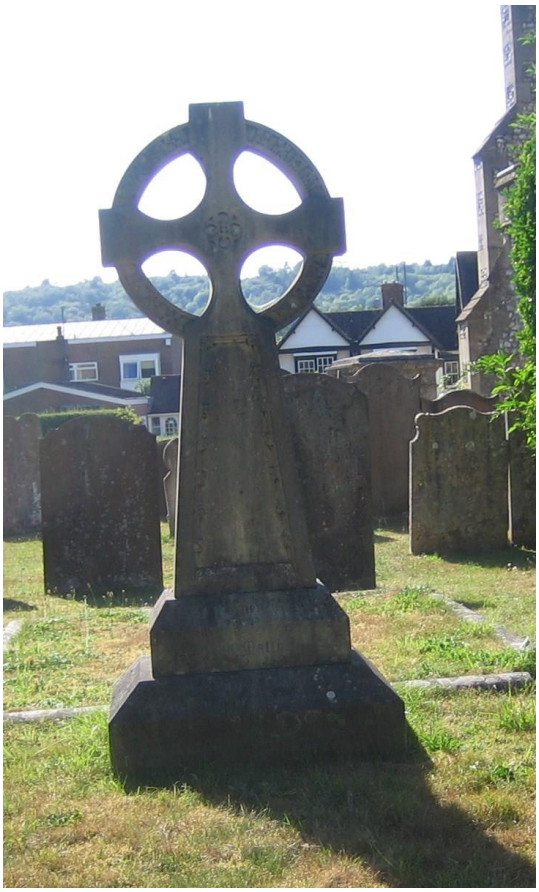


(17) Thomas Filewood (1745 - 1800)

Thomas Filewood became the Rector at St. Michael's in 1771. He is famous as the parson who married Fanny Burney to General d'Arbly the French émigré on 31st July 1793. During his 29 years as rector from 1771 to 1800 he took an active part in parish affairs, attending every vestry meeting until 1796, whilst at the same time he held the living of Dunsfold in Surrey.

Sadly, towards the end of the century and at the age of only 55, his health was failing. He was almost blind, and helped by his daughter, had learnt to repeat the services from memory. On Sunday 10th August 1800, the sound of a pistol shot was heard coming from the rectory and people rushed in to find the study door locked. Rev. Filewood, not long returned from conducting evensong, had locked himself in and when the door was burst open, he was found dead with the pistol by his side. Firearms were commonly carried as a defence against highwaymen and his son, on a visit to his father, had left the loaded pistol on the library table.

(See also (24) Rebecca Reynolds)



(18) Sir James John Trevor Lawrence (1831 – 1913)

Lady Elizabeth Lawrence (1848 – 1916)

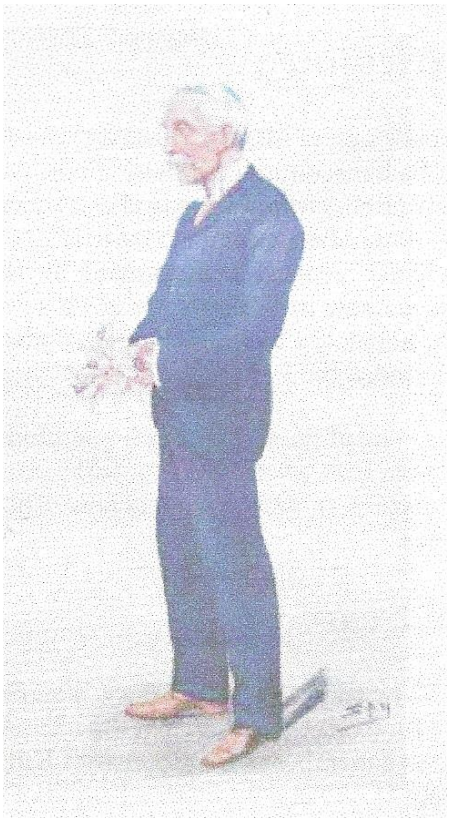
James John Trevor Lawrence was born on 30 December 1831, the son of Sir William Lawrence and Louisa Senior, the daughter of a successful Mayfair haberdasher who had bought a country estate in Buckinghamshire and moved up the social ladder through horticulture. He was educated at Winchester College and at St.Bartholomew's Hospital, where he took the diploma of MRCS in 1853. He then worked for nearly ten years for the Indian Medical Service. Having inherited his mother's particular love for orchids, he reinforced this when he was in India. He made his first collection when living at Dharamsala in the Himalayan foothills. On the death of his father in 1867 he became the 2nd Baronet of Ealing Park.

In 1869 he married Elizabeth Matthew, daughter of John Matthew, a partner in the leading firm of marine engineers, John Penn & Son of Greenwich. Later she inherited Burford Lodge in Mickleham, where they created a celebrated garden.

In 1875 he was elected MP for Mid Surrey and sat for that constituency for ten years until it was abolished in 1885, when he was elected for Reigate, a seat he held for seven years. He did not seek re-election at the 1892 general election.

Lawrence's main interest however was horticulture and from 1885 to 1913 he was President of the Royal Horticultural Society. He was chiefly responsible for moving the society from Kensington to a more practical home in Westminster in 1904.

He was one of the world's leading orchid collectors and asked his wife to give plants of botanical interest to Kew after his death, 580 were thought to qualify. He presided at the RHS conference on hybridisation in 1899, which is now officially regarded as the first international conference on genetics.



On 9th November 1902 he was created KCVO and was also a Knight of the Order of St. John of Jerusalem. He was a well-known collector of objects d'art, particularly oriental, especially Japanese art, western porcelain and old lace. Some of his collector's items are now in the Victoria and Albert Museum and other museums.

The four larger church bells, completing the peal of six, were given by Dame Elizabeth Lawrence in memory of Sir James who died in 1913 and there is a dedication plaque in the church on the west wall. Sadly she died at the age of 68 in March 1916 and so was not able to be present at the service of dedication held on the evening of 21st June 1916.

Sir W.M.T. Lawrence *and* ***Lady B.I. Lawrence*** *son and daughter in law of* ***Sir James John Trevor Lawrence*** *are also buried within this family grave.*

Sir William Matthew Trevor Lawrence (1870 – 1934)
Lady Bertha Iris Lawrence (1887 – 1955)

William Matthew Trevor Lawrence was born on 17th September 1870, the son of Sir James John Trevor Lawrence and Elizabeth Matthew. He was educated at Shrewsbury School and at New College, Oxford. On 24th February 1908 he married Iris Eyre, daughter of Brig-General Eyre Macdonnell Stewart Crabbe, CB.

On succeeding in 1913 to his father's title and estate at Burford, he became free to live a public life, especially in the fields of horticulture, medical administration and the collection of objects of fine art.

During the First World War he served as Secretary of the Prisoners of War Information Bureau. Later he was attached to the Admiralty war staff, and then to the Intelligence branch of the War Office.

Both his father and grandfather had been important figures in the medical world; his grandfather (Sir William Lawrence) was a pioneering surgeon and Sergeant-Surgeon to Queen Victoria, and his father (Sir Trevor Lawrence, M.P.) chaired the Central Hospital Council and was a treasurer of St. Bartholomew's Hospital. William himself was Almoner of the same hospital, and actually died there while on hospital business. He was also a Justice of the Peace for Surrey.

Of course his chief interest was horticulture, an interest he had inherited from his father and grandmother, both horticulturists of note. He was President of the Alpine Garden Society, an officer of the Odre du Merite Agricole, a winner of the Victoria Medal of Honour and Vice-President of the Iris Society. He wrote the foreword for the society florist Constance Spry's first book 'Flower Decoration'. Lady Lawrence was also a keen gardener, winning the Victoria Medal of Honour in her own right.

Lady Iris continued to live at Burford Lodge for another 20 years until her death in June 1955.

Rose Gray MBE, co-founder of "The River Cafe" who died on 28th February 2010 was the granddaughter of Sir William Lawrence.

(19) Lieutenant Colonel Sir John Norton-Griffiths (1871 – 1930)



Sir John Norton-Griffiths, 1st Baronet KCB DSO, known as 'Empire Jack' for his keenness for all things imperial, or sometimes 'Hell-fire Jack', was a British Member of Parliament and soldier in World War I. Prior to the war he established an engineering company, Giffiths & Co., which specialised in the construction of tunnels through clay. He was also referred to as an arsonist and tunnel-maker and often described as eccentric, enigmatic and extraordinary. He was a keen supporter of Liverpool Football Club and was a director of Arsenal Football Club between 1928 and 1930.

Born John Griffiths in Somerset on 13th July 1871, he left home at the age of 17 and went to Australia where he worked in engineering, excavating and tunnelling for some years. He then moved to South Africa where he took part in the Matabele War (1869-1897) and the Anglo Boer War (1899-1902). In 1901 he returned to London and married Gwladys before going off to mine in West Africa.

The family set up home in Mole Cottage at Westhumble and by 1909 had four children. In 1910 John was elected to parliament firstly, for Wednesbury and then Wandsworth Central which he served until October 1924. During this time he spent periods in Africa and South America, where his company was busy constructing railways.

He returned home and at the outbreak of war in 1914, organised and equipped the second regiment of King Edward's Horse. He also persuaded the British War Office to establish mining companies to excavate tunnels under the German lines, using the techniques perfected by his own company (known as clay-kicking). He built many fortifications on the Western Front and took to touring the trenches in a battered Rolls Royce loaded with crates of fine wines.



Perhaps his most important contribution came when he was sent early on in the war to sabotage the Romanian oil fields. He was able, almost single-handedly, to destroy 70 refineries and 8,000 tons of crude oil. He was awarded the Distinguished Service Order in 1916 and was promoted Lieutenant-Colonel in 1918.

After the war, in November 1918, John and his wife bought Wonham Manor in Betchworth and on 14th June 1922 he was created 1st Baronet of Wonham. He returned to his work in the construction industry and served as MP for Wandsworth until 1924. In 1929 the Egyptian government decided to raise the height of the Aswan dam and the contract was awarded to Norton-Griffiths & Co. There were various disputes and work ground to a halt on 21st September 1930. On 27th September Jack Norton-Griffiths, by now aged 59, was found dead in a small boat a short distance from the shore near Alexandria. It appeared that he had committed suicide.

A sad end to the life of a truly remarkable man who, by his personal characteristics, his skills and determination, had made a dramatic contribution to the successful outcome of the 1914 – 1918 war.

Sir John's widow Gwladys lived on for another 44 years and died on 1st June 1974 at the age of 101. Her funeral was attended by her grandson Jeremy Thorpe, leader of the Liberal Party from 1967 – 1976. His mother prior to her marriage to John Henry Thorpe had been Ursula Norton-Griffiths daughter of Sir John and Lady Gwladys. At the funeral Jeremy read the lesson and for some reason the lectern had to be moved to the other side of the chancel steps. There is a brass memorial dedicated to Sir John in the church on the south wall below some hatchments.





Funeral Hatchment for Mary Jenkinson

(20) Mary & David Jenkinson

A fine example of a chest style tomb with an interesting inscription and a coat of arms:

Sacred to the memory of Mary Jenkinson, the wife of David Jenkinson of Juniper Hall at Mickleham in this County, Esq., who after 24 years uniform attention to all conjugal duties, and the practice of every social virtue, calmly resigned her soul to the Author of all nature on the 16th day of October, 1785, in the 51st year of her age. Also the body of David Jenkinson, Esq, who died July 20, 1799, aged 67 years.

On the other side of the tomb:

In memory of David Philip Jenkinson, Esq., son of David and Mary Jenkinson, who departed this life March 22, 1803, aged 36 years.

David Jenkinson senior was a wealthy lottery agent and after the death of Sir Cecil Bisshop he bought Juniper Hall, where in 1780 the Cedars of Lebanon were planted, some of which still stand today. Also at that time the skeletons of two Anglo-Saxons were found while the house was being extended. He then built Juniper Hill and decided to let Juniper Hall in 1792 to a group of French émigrés, that included General d'Arblay, who later married Fanny Burney.

There is a funeral hatchment to Mary Jenkinson in the church on the north wall. These were paintings of coats of arms in large diamond-shaped black wooden frames. From about 1600 when an important person died, they were displayed over the entrance to the house of the deceased person during the period of mourning, usually for six to twelve months, and then given to the church.

In addition to the person's coat of arms, the decoration indicated the person's lifetime achievements, and honours. Also whether the deceased was male or female, single or married and if so, whether the spouse had died before or after.

The eight hatchments in St. Michael's Church were refurbished in 2008.



Funeral hatchments on the North Wall.



(21) Headstone Design

Note the distinctive top of this 18th century grey limestone headstone. It is very unusual but in some ways similar to others nearby. Probably all the handiwork of the same stonemason and possibly his trademark. It is also beautifully colonised by lichen that love the clean air of the churchyard. Remarkably, these organisms can live for hundreds of years!

On 7th February 2009 the Daily Telegraph published an article on lichens and it was reported that St. Michael's and its churchyard had more than 100 types. At the time this was the record for the greatest number of lichens recorded in a churchyard.

In Memory of
SAMUEL FULLER
Tallow Chandler died December
The 28th 1760 Aged 49 Years
Also
FRUSANNA FULLER
Relict of
SAMUEL FULLER
Died March 16 1780 Aged 62
Years



(22) John, Ruth & Eliza Letford

Note this very sad inscription:

TO THE MEMORY OF
JOHN LETFORD
WHO DIED FEBRUARY 12TH 1826
AGED 64 YEARS.
ALSO
RUTH, WIFE OF THE ABOVE
WHO DIED JULY 10TH 1824
AGED 59YEARS.
ALSO
ELIZA LETFORD
DAUGHTER OF THE ABOVE
DIED IN THE PARISH OF CHELSEA,
MIDDLESEX ON THE 22ND DEC 1849
AFTER 17 MONTHS AND FIFTEEN
DAYS SEVERE AFFLICTION, WHICH SHE
BORE WITH TRUE
CHRISTIAN PIETY AND,
A RESIGNATION WORTHY
OF EXAMPLE.
AGED 46 YEARS.
HER END WAS PEACE.



(23) Robert James Mortimore (1847 – 1907)

Robert Mortimore was the Headmaster at The National School, located in Byttom Hill opposite the Almshouses in Mickleham, for 33 years. He was ably assisted in his duties by his wife and in December 1899, a testimonial was presented to them on completion of twenty five years long service in the Parish and in celebration of their Silver Wedding. They received many letters from old scholars, some of whom were serving in South Africa in the Boer War, to mark their respect for their former schoolmaster and valued friend.

Robert and his wife and three children moved to The School House in Byttom Hill in 1874, not long after a notice had been served on the parish under the Education Act of 1870 that extra accommodation must be provided for twenty six infants. As a result an Infant Classroom, divided by folding doors from the main room, so that they could be used as one large room for public meetings and lectures etc., had been added in 1872. The cost was met by a voluntary rate and the school became known as a Public Elementary School. By 1874 the Managing Committee could boast that under the auspices of the

schoolmaster and his wife, aided by the small Infant School at Westhumble, every child in the parish could receive efficient teaching.

However, the old school, built in 1843, became unsuitable and inadequate for the increasing number of children, and on 26th July 1907 the foundation stone for a new school was laid by the Bishop of Dorking. The site of the new school lay on the south side of Byttom Hill next to the allotments and a new access road had to be cut through. This came to be known as School Lane. The headmaster at the time was C. Viney and the headmistress Robert's widow, Jesse Margaret Mortimore. By this time she had moved to Thorne Cottage, Mickleham where she died aged 82 in 1928.



Mrs Mortimore and two of her daughters

From the school log of the time it was clear that Robert was more than just a head teacher. He was a musician and sometimes played the organ, a great organiser of events and festivities and all in all a general factotum. As his health began to fail his log entries became very poignant and he died at The School House on 25th February 1907 only a few months before the new school was begun.

His headstone reads:

Affectionate Remembrance
Of
ROBERT JAMES MORTIMORE
WHO DIED FEBRUARY 25th 1907
AGED 60 YEARS
FOR 33 YEARS HEAD MASTER OF THE SCHOOLS
OF THIS PARISH. DURING WHICH PERIOD HE WON
THE ESTEEM AND REGARD OF ALL WHO KNEW HIM.



(24) Rebecca Reynolds (1788 – 1887)

Mrs Reynolds lived with her husband at the North Lodge, Juniper Hill, Mickleham, where he was lodgekeeper. It was here that she ran her little 'dame's school' after his death in 1832. She carried on teaching until she was 89 and lived on until 28th February 1887 when she died at the age of 99, just one year short of her century.

It appears almost beyond belief that there was no Public or National School in the parish until 1843 and that dame schools were the only resort for the education of the children of artisans and labourers in rural areas. Indeed in the 1860s few country children were in school after the age of ten and before education became more or less compulsory, through the 1870 Elementary Education Act, village children in poorer parts of the country had to take pot luck.

It was Rebecca who, as a young girl of twelve actually heard the pistol shot which killed Rev. Filewood in 1880. (See (17) Thomas Filewood).



(25) Elizabeth & Thomas Tapner

Another interesting inscription, this time on a double width headstone, possibly indicating burial side-by-side?

IN
MEMORY OF
MRS ELIZ. Wife of
MR THOMS. TAPNER
Who died
March 31 1771
Aged 43 Years
My latter days on earth
To me was grief through pain
But yet I trust in CHRIST
By him to Rise again.

IN
MEMORY OF
MR THOMS. TAPNER
Carrier of Dorking
Who died
Dec 9 1798
Aged 70 Years
Poesy's on Monuments,
Are mainly Spent
A good Man's Life
Tis his Monument.



(26) War Memorial

The war memorial was erected in 1920 and dedicated by Archdeacon Robinson of Surrey on 16th July 1920. Those commemorated:

1914 - 1918

Pte. Frederick Berryman, 11th Bn. The Queen's (Royal West Surrey Regiment)

* Bombardier Percy Bodman, Royal Garrison Artillery

Pte. Sidney Bruford, 6th Bn. The Queen's (Royal West Surrey Regiment)

Edward Clarke

Pte. William Collins, 6th Bn. The Queen's (Royal West Surrey Regiment)

Pte. Henry Edgington, 7th Bn. East Surrey Regiment

Pte. William Edgington,13th Bn. Australian Infantry,AIF

Frederick Field

Lt. Col. Bernard Grissell DSO, Cdg, 1st/5th Bn, Norfolk Regiment

Lt. Francis Grissell, 1st Bn. Coldstream Guards

Pte. Oliver Snelling, 1st Bn. Royal Warwickshire Regiment

(27) War Memorial



1939 – 1945

Those commemorated:

Sgt. Dennis Barber, Royal Air Force Volunteer Reserve, 9 Sqn.

Stwd. Ralph Blackman, Royal Navy, HM Boom Defence Vessel, 'Thomas Connolly'

Cpl. Kenneth Butcher, Royal Air Force Volunteer Reserve

Lt. Allan Foxton, Royal Naval Volunteer Reserve

Capt. Roger Lawrence, 155 Bty. 172 Field Regiment

Sgt. Derryck Northfield, Royal Air Force Volunteer Reserve, 101 Squadron

* Lt. Peter Odhams, Royal Navy

Donald Pearce

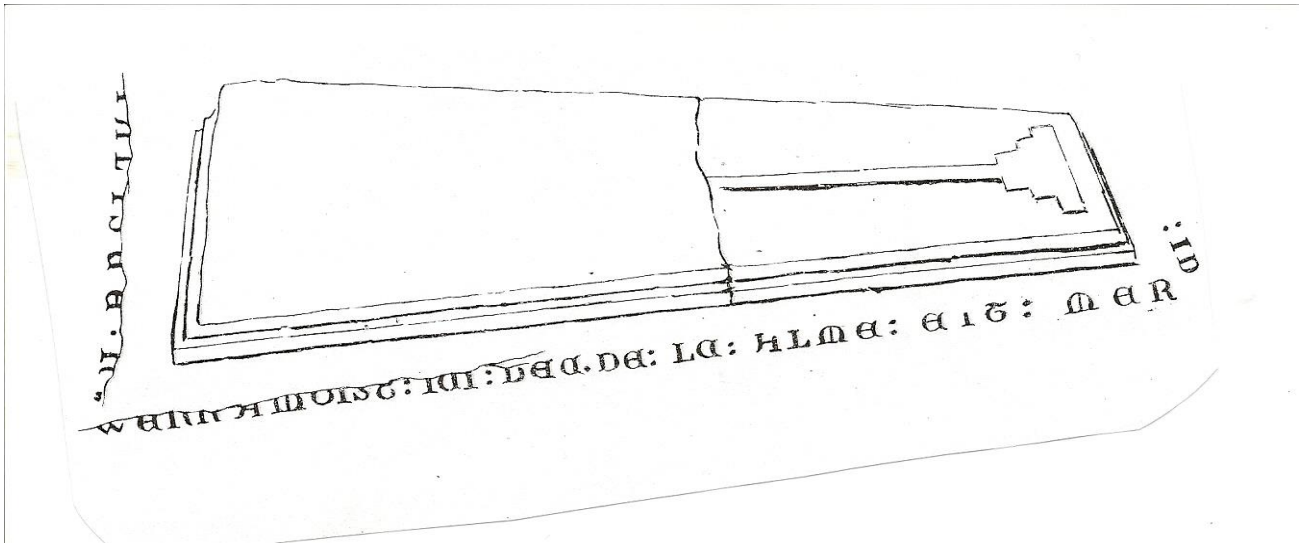
Harald Phipps

L.Sgt. Edgar Sawyer, 1st /5th Bn.The Queen's (Royal West Surrey Regiment)

Brimley Williams

** Buried in St. Michael's Churchyard and recognised by the Commonwealth War Graves Commission*

(A more comprehensive guide to those commemorated has been prepared by Mickleham and Westhumble Local History Group).



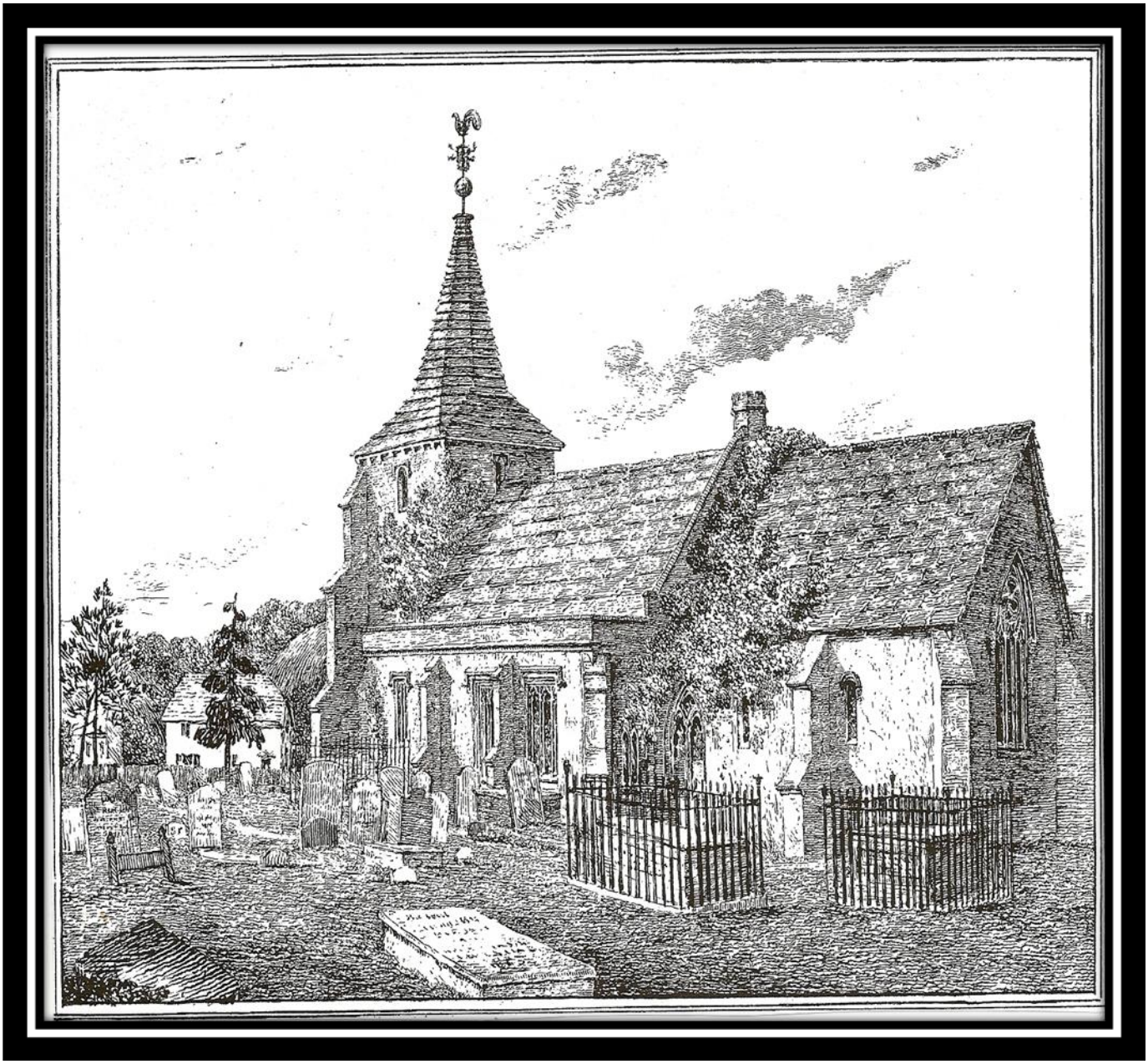
(28) Porch Tombs

During the 1823 Victorian restoration of the church the ground was lowered around the north door and two ancient tombs dating from about 1330 were discovered, each with a legend in the Longobardic script neatly chiselled in a hollow on the edges of the stone. They are both six inches in thickness with the upper surfaces damaged by time so that the foot of a cross is all that is visible on each tomb. With a view to the future preservation of these ancient monuments, they were placed in the porch and raised upon brickwork so as to form stone seats.




Organ Chamber
Pulpit
Revell's Vestry
Choir Vestry
Newbury Chapel
19
18
17
20
16
15
14
13
12


Mickleham old Churchyard.
Numerous graves have no stones, on every part of the Churchyard there have been burials.
Mickleham Easter Vestry
Tuesday 8th April 1913
presented by A. Gordon Salcott, Rector's Warden
Rock marked thus + but not accurate in the exact site and shape of the land.
Chas. F.
FLATT
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St. Michael and All Angels Church **Circa 1800**